same concessionaire brought in considerable business and the pricing of PNG was just about the same as LPG. Most important, the laying of PNG and CNG infrastructure, which is far more demanding than optical fibre, was administratively facilitated. Likewise, appropriate policy incentives in the form of all digital services being delivered through fibre, reducing the cost of laying fibre infrastructure and facilitating its laying, would be vital to realize the policy goal of ‘Fibre to All’ expressed in the National Digital Communications Policy, 2018 (NDCP-2018).

The satellite business is not reserved for the public sector under IDRA-1951. However, only the Space Commission and Government of India organizations were allowed to develop and launch satellites. What was not done by law was achieved by administrative fiat. ISRO and other public institutions, however, have done a fabulous job of making and launching satellites, providing excellent quality at most competitive costs. However, not allowing the private sector has constrained the use of satellites in the expansion of digital infrastructure.

The Government of India permitted the private sector to enter the satellite business in 2020 by revoking the administrative decision. One hopes this decision is implemented without any constraints and backroom controls. Indian entrepreneurs have the potential to make the country a global satellite manufacture and launching hub.

All considered, the combination of fibre to every building (home and business), 5G spectrum and satellites for all digital applications should help India create world-class digital infrastructure and pave the way for digitalization of the Indian economy, businesses and households.